10-26 第二篇

The Invisible World of Microbes

We cannot see them with our eyes, but they are everywhere. Microbes—tiny living things like bacteria and viruses—live in the air, in the soil, in the water, and even inside our bodies. They are so small that millions can fit on the tip of a finger, yet they play a huge role in life on Earth. [1] Microbes are the most abundant forms of life on our planet, and without them, many of the processes that keep the natural world running would simply stop.

Some microbes help us stay healthy. Our gut is home to billions of bacteria that help digest food and support our immune system. Yogurt and cheese are made with the help of friendly bacteria. Scientists are still learning how these tiny organisms affect our health, mood, and even our weight. [2] The more we understand about our relationship with microbes, the better we can use this knowledge to improve human health and treat disease.

Not all microbes are helpful, of course. Some bacteria and viruses can cause illness, and throughout history they have led to serious outbreaks. Yet the same tools we use to fight harmful microbes—such as vaccines and antibiotics—would not exist without studying how microbes work. [3] Learning about both helpful and harmful microbes is essential for medicine, as it helps us prevent illness and develop new treatments.

Microbes also matter for the environment. They break down dead plants and animals, turning them into nutrients that new life can use. They help plants grow by fixing nitrogen in the soil. In the ocean, microbes produce much of the oxygen we breathe. [4] From recycling nutrients to producing oxygen, microbes are fundamental to the balance of nature and the survival of countless species.

Because microbes are so small and diverse, scientists have only begun to understand them. New discoveries are made every year, and many questions remain. [5] The invisible world of microbes holds many secrets that may one day help us solve some of our biggest challenges, from fighting disease to protecting the environment.

选项

A. Microbes are the most abundant forms of life on our planet, and without them, many of the processes that keep the natural world running would simply stop. B. The more we understand about our relationship with microbes, the better we can use this knowledge to improve human health and treat disease. C. Learning about both helpful and harmful microbes is essential for medicine, as it helps us prevent illness and develop new treatments. D. From recycling nutrients to producing oxygen, microbes are fundamental

to the balance of nature and the survival of countless species. E. The invisible world of microbes holds many secrets that may one day help us solve some of our biggest challenges, from fighting disease to protecting the environment. F. For example, Lactobacillus bacteria in yogurt help break down lactose and make the product easier to digest for many people.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍微生物无处不在、极小却作用巨大，空后需概括其在地球生命中的核心地位。A的"most abundant forms of life"与"millions can fit on the tip of a finger"呼应数量，"without them... processes would stop"承接"huge role"，逻辑完整。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说部分微生物有益健康——肠道菌、酸奶奶酪、影响健康与情绪，空后需总结认识与利用的关系。B的"The more we understand about our relationship with microbes"承接前文研究，"improve human health and treat disease"与肠道、免疫、消化等例呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说有害微生物致病，但疫苗和抗生素也源于对微生物的研究，空后需概括医学研究需兼顾利弊。C的"Learning about both helpful and harmful microbes"与空前对比呼应，"essential for medicine... prevent illness and develop new treatments"与疫苗、抗生素逻辑一致。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前列举微生物的生态作用——分解、固氮、产氧，空后需总结其生态学意义。D的"From recycling nutrients to producing oxygen"直接对应空前三个例子，"fundamental to the balance of nature"与前文生态功能形成概括。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说微生物研究才起步、每年有新发现、仍有许多未知，空后需展望其潜在价值。E的"holds many secrets"与"many questions remain"呼应，"solve... biggest challenges, from fighting disease to protecting the environment"与全文两大主题（健康与生态）收尾。

- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example, Lactobacillus bacteria in yogurt help break down lactose and make the product easier to digest for many people.**：以For example开头，为具体菌种与食品举例。各空均为概括句；[2]虽涉及有益细菌与酸奶，但需的是"理解与利用关系"的概括，而非单个益生菌案例。